

Prayer at Daybreak - Archimandrite Sophronios

O Lord Eternal and Creator of all things,
Who of Thy inscrutable goodness called me
to this life;
Who bestowed on me the grace of Baptism
and the Seal of the Holy Spirit;
Who imbued me with the desire to seek
Thee,
the one true God: hear my prayer.
I have no life, no light, no joy or wisdom;
no strength except in Thee, O God.
Because of my unrighteousness I dare not
raise my eyes to Thee.
But Thou said to Thy disciples,
'Whatsoever you shall ask in prayer
believing, you shall receive.'
and 'Whatsoever you shall ask in my name,
that will I do.'
Wherefore I dare to invoke Thee.
Purify me from all taint of flesh and spirit.
Teach me to pray aright.
Bless this day which Thee give unto me,
Thy unworthy servant.
By the power of Thy blessing enable me at
all times to speak
and act to Thy glory with a pure spirit, with
humility, patience, love, gentleness, peace,
courage and wisdom:
aware always of Thy presence.

Of Thy immense goodness, O Lord God,
show me the path of Thy will,
and grant me to walk in Thy sight without
sin.
O Lord, unto Whom all hearts be open,
Thee know what things I have need of.
Thee are acquainted with my blindness and
my ignorance,
Thee know my infirmity and my soul's
corruption;
but neither are my pain and anguish hid
from Thee.
Wherefore I beseech Thee, hear my prayer
and by Thy Holy Spirit
teach me the way wherein I should walk;
and when my perverted will would lead me
down other paths
spare me not O Lord, but force me back to
Thee.
By the power of Thy love, grant me to hold
fast to that which is good.
Preserve me from every word or deed that
corrupts the soul;
from every impulse displeasing in Thy sight
and hurtful to my brother-man.
Teach me what I should say and how I
should speak.
If it be Thy will that I make no answer,

inspire me to keep silent in a spirit of peace
that causes neither sorrow nor hurt to my
fellow man.

Establish me in the path of Thy
commandments

and to my last breath let me not stray from
the light of Thy ordinances,

that Thy commandments may become the
sole law

of my being on this earth and all eternity.

Yea, Lord, I pray to Thee, have pity on me.

Spare me in my affliction and my misery
and hide not the way of salvation from me.

In my foolishness, O God, I plead with Thee
for many and great things.

Yet am I ever mindful of my wickedness,
my baseness, my vileness.

Have mercy upon me.

Cast me not away from your presence
because of my presumption.

Do Thee rather increase in me this
presumption,

and grant unto me, the worst of men,
to love Thee as Thee have commanded, with
all my heart, and with all my soul,

and with all my mind, and with all my
strength:

with my whole being.

Yea, O Lord, by Thy Holy Spirit, teach me
good judgment and knowledge.

Grant me to know Thy truth before I go
down into the grave.

Maintain my life in this world until I may
offer unto Thee worthy repentance.

Take me not away in the midst of my days,
nor while my mind is still blind.

When Thee shall be pleased to bring my life
to an end,

forewarn me that I may prepare my soul to
come before Thee.

Be with me, O Lord, at that dread hour and
grant me the joy of salvation.

Cleanse me from secret faults, from all
iniquity that is hidden in me;

and give me a right answer before Thy
judgment-seat.

Yea, Lord, of Thy great mercy and
immeasurable love for mankind.

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